

EUROPEAN CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE

ONE NETWORK, NINE COUNTRIES

Impersonation of European critical-infrastructure operators across the thirteen sectors named in the NIS2 Directive. The most serious finding is not a phishing page — it is a **single coordinated investment-fraud operation of 608 domains** running against European financial trust institutions in at least nine countries and eight languages.

192 entities · 13 NIS2 sectors 1 Jan – 1 Aug 2026 liveness verified 1 Aug 2026

608

domains in one investment-fraud network

420

confirmed still hosting on 1 August

513

credential & payment lures assessed

199d

longest continuously live

01 KEY JUDGEMENTS

HIGH **A single operation, not a format.** 608 domains form one coordinated network. Pages on three unrelated domains are **byte-identical at 48,902 bytes**; a shared `..int/send.php` lead-capture path appears across Polish, Czech, Spanish, Italian, French, Turkish and Argentine variants.

HIGH **This is an attack on the credibility of public financial institutions, not merely on a brand.** It impersonates national central banks, a sovereign investment fund, and fabricated government-backed savings programmes. The most heavily impersonated individual in the dataset is **Klaas Knot, President of De Nederlandsche Bank** (23 domains).

HIGH **The majority carries no brand token** and is therefore invisible to typosquat, permutation and domain-monitoring logic. Every query in this assessment matched the brand *as rendered in the page*; domains were classified as token-bearing or not purely to measure what domain-based tooling would have missed.

HIGH **Procurement is batched, not organic.** 599 domains carry registration dates across 109 days, but **27 of those days each carry eight or more registrations**.

MODERATE **Distribution is paid, not organic.** The Polish pages load `analytics.tiktok.com`, indicating the fabricated articles are promoted through paid TikTok advertising.

02

FINDING 1 — A PAN-EUROPEAN INVESTMENT-FRAUD NETWORK

The operation publishes a fabricated news article — typically a national broadcaster's programme in which a banker, regulator or politician is accused *on air* of robbing ordinary citizens — which then routes the reader into a fraudulent "AI trading" platform.

EVIDENCE	WHAT WAS OBSERVED
Byte-identical deployment	Pages on <code>softarc[.]ink</code> , <code>pinhaze[.]buzz</code> and <code>piazzapulita[.]buzz</code> are each exactly 48,902 bytes — the same file on three unrelated domains
Shared fraud platforms	The same named platforms recur across language waves: BitKeltTrade (138 domains), QuantumAi (169), Immediate Edge (189), plus Cezthronix, Nawrogrenix, ZolontrixFin, LuzentrixFin, IcrypexAI
Common lead-capture endpoint	A shared <code>../int/send.php</code> submission path across seven language variants
Bulk same-day registration	27 days each carrying eight or more registrations — batch procurement
Machine-generated naming	One batch drawn from a fixed morpheme pool (<code>aetherithvenixara</code> , <code>quorvenithraxith</code>); an English batch follows a rigid adjective-noun-media pattern (<code>brightleafmanual</code> , <code>clearpinechannel</code>)
Paid social distribution	Polish pages load TikTok analytics — promoted, not left to organic discovery

Countries targeted



Domains by targeted audience.

Institutions used as the lure

Public institutions are the lure, not incidental. The operation impersonates **De Nederlandsche Bank** and its President **Klaas Knot** (23 domains), the **Deutsche Bundesbank**, and the Belgian sovereign fund **SFPIM**.

Polish variants advertise a fictitious "*Oficjalny program rządowy*" and a "*Platforma wspierana przez rząd*" — a government-backed investment platform that does not exist.

Real journalists and programmes are used as credibility props: **Eva Jinek**, **Jort Kelder**, **Kees van der Spek**, the Dutch programme *Op1*, and Corrado Formigli's *Piazzapulita* on La7.

03 FINDING 2 — CENTRAL BANK IMPERSONATION

Nineteen domains impersonate the Deutsche Bundesbank. **Every one carries no brand token.** Several go beyond a cloned homepage into a product the Bundesbank does not offer.

Advance-fee lending under a central bank's name

bundeskredit[.]com, bundeskreditsu[.]com and bundeskriit[.]com advertise "*Deutsche Bundesbank — Kredit auf Ihre Bedingungen*".

The Bundesbank does not provide retail lending. These are advance-fee loan frauds using a central bank's identity as the guarantee of legitimacy.

zahlungsdetails[.]digital — a domain name meaning "payment details" — serves "*Deutsche Bundesbank — Bundesrepublik Deutschland*".

Why this exposure is easy to miss

A cluster of get-rich-themed domains — reichwwerden[.]com, wealthbuldder[.]com, weallthdewave[.]com, smartllife[.]com, finanzzfuchs[.]com — all serve the Bundesbank homepage title.

A central bank has no retail customers, so it has little reason to watch for consumer-facing impersonation of itself — which is precisely what makes its name useful to a fraudster.

04

FINDING 3 — TAX AUTHORITIES AND NATIONAL EID

The highest-consequence credentials in the public-administration estate: they unlock tax records, benefits, health data and — in several member states — the ability to **sign legally binding documents**.

COUNTRY / SERVICE	OBSERVED
Germany — ELSTER	"ELSTER Digitale Bestätigung Ihrer Kryptowährungsbestände" — a fabricated requirement to confirm cryptocurrency holdings to the tax authority, alongside "IBAN Bestätigung" and "Datenaktualisierung" variants
Netherlands — Belastingdienst	verzuimtermijn[.]bond serves a "Verzuimboete 2026" default-penalty notice; doorgevenbelddienst[.]com a "Crypto-aangifte"; plus a run of "Betalingsportaal" pages
Denmark — MitID / NemLog-in	digital-login[.]app and dinpersonligebox[.]com both serve the national single-sign-on page
Netherlands — DigiD	bigbab-co[.]lol serves the DigiD login

One instance did not use registered infrastructure at all. A Belastingdienst payment-portal page was found running on webradiovencendocomjesus[.]com[.]br, a **compromised Brazilian community-radio site**. The operator did not register a domain — they took someone else's. No domain-registration signal exists for that case at any point.

05 FINDING 4 — SECTOR CLUSTERS

Groups of distinct domains serving the same page — one kit, deployed repeatedly. Cluster size is the total observed in the window; "live" is what was still serving on 1 August 2026.

ENTITY	PAGE SERVED	DOMAINS	LIVE
Telefónica	movistar portal de recaudos	64	0
BBVA	kendim için garanti bbva	43	1
Volksbank	startseite ihrer volksbank in der region eg	30	0
Swedbank	swedbank – žmogaus patvirtinimas	25	0
Telefónica	pagar factura movistar online epayc	24	22
Volksbank	volksbank online-banking — tan-verfahren erneuern	16	0
Commerzbank	anmeldung zum digital banking — commerzbank	14	0
Alpha Bank	alpha bank	10	3
BankID	bankid felsökning	9	2
SNCF	vérification de sécurité — sncf connect	8	0
Bundesbank	startseite deutsche bundesbank	8	2

SNCF Connect — naming without the operator

Eight domains, **all no-token**, all serving "*Vérification de sécurité — SNCF Connect*": `tgw-promo[.]com`, `promo-tgw[.]com`, `tgw-avantage[.]com`, `carte-avantages48[.]com`, `avantages-inoui[.]com`.

The naming is built around **discount-card and promotional language** rather than the operator's name.

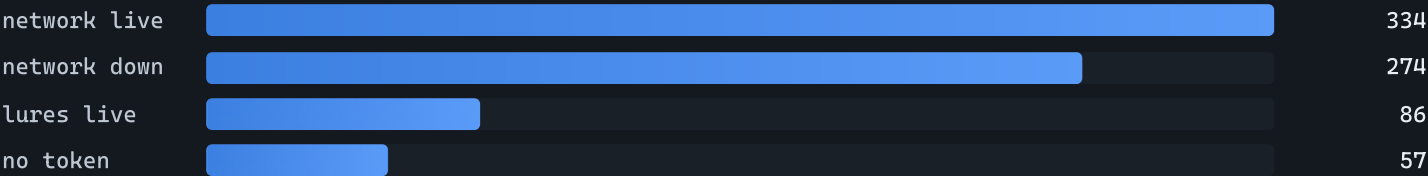
Swedbank, Commerzbank, parcel

Swedbank (Lithuania) — ten newly registered random-word domains serving a fake human-verification gate, of the type used to deliver clipboard-injection attacks.

Commerzbank (Germany) — `cmz-verfahren-erneuern[.]sbs`, `neues-verfahren[.]sbs`, built on the German phrase for "renew your procedure", the standard pretext for harvesting banking authentication credentials.

Parcel and postal — DPD and GLS clusters serving cloned German, Dutch, Slovak and UK tracking pages: the highest-volume consumer fraud vector in Europe, driven by customs-fee and redelivery lures.

Still serving on 1 August 2026



334 of 608 investment-fraud network domains and 86 of the credential/payment lures — of which 57 carry no brand token.

Longest-lived, still serving

DOMAIN	REGISTERED	DAYS
achteraf[.]com	2026-01-14	199
handmadepromiseco[.]com	2026-02-06	176
pryrodenist[.]ink	2026-02-17	165
venturecopilots[.]com	2026-03-08	146
bitlaro[.]net	2026-04-21	102
the-irish-independent[.]com	2026-04-29	94

A note on the O'Leary domains. A substantial block of the long-lived network domains carry ordinary personal-site titles — wedding websites, speech therapy practices, design studios, all named O'Leary. These are the residue of the Ryanair-CEO investment-fraud wave: names procured for their surname value and then parked on innocuous content. They are reported as network members on registration and kit evidence, not on their current page content.

1

Content, not domains. Every query matched the brand as rendered in the page title. Domains were then classified as token-bearing or not, purely to measure what domain-based tooling would have missed.

2

Registration pairing. Each finding is paired with the registration date of its domain, taken from the newly-registered-domain feed that first surfaced it — giving both the detection gap and the exposure window.

3

Liveness re-verified. Every domain was re-scanned on 1 August 2026. "Live" means it was serving the impersonating content on that date.

4

Hypotheses were tested, not assumed. Where the data suggested a conclusion it was checked against controls before being written down. Several promising leads failed those checks and were removed; they are documented rather than hidden.

Attribution basis. Cluster attribution rests on shared page content, byte-level file identity, common lead-capture endpoints, batch registration and kit fingerprinting. **Co-location on shared hosting is not treated as evidence.** No systems belonging to any named organisation were accessed and no non-public information was used.